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SUNRO MINE

Plenty of Water 'But No Hazard'

By AB KENT
Business Reporter

After two years of costly "dehydration" in flooded Sunro Mine at Jordan River, plenty of water remains.

But Cowichan Copper Co. president Oswood MacDonald said the amount of water coursing through the underground workings presents "no hazard at all."

He says there is no more or no less water at Sunro than in many another mine.

But the stope through which the Jordan River bottom crashed with disastrous results in December, 1963, is still partly open.

Mine manager Jack McIntosh told shareholders recently that tailings from the ore concentrator—also located underground—would be pumped into the stope in the regular course of mining.

Ultimately, the stope would be capped with more concrete, he said.

Mr. MacDonald pointed out last week that a series of strong concrete bulkheads are part of the undertaking that rehabilitated the mine and allowed production to resume last month.

He said the water involved with the underground workings now is at "less pressure than your kitchen tap."

It is natural to encounter water courses when tunnelling under water tables, he said.

Generally, the water can be controlled for use in connection with pumping tailings and diamond drilling.

Getting the mine back into operation to fulfill its profitable Japanese commitments to ship concentrates at the world's highest prices represented a major engineering achievement.

Jordan River had to be diverted away from the cave-in, the collapsed portions of the mine secured, water pumped out and machinery restored, and outside installations swept away by a landslide were rebuilt.

Now, Mr. MacDonald says, there is no reason why ore in the vicinity of the river bed may not be mined, provided conditions are suitable.

In lower "B" mine the ore might be taken out by the block-caving method, he said.

Hoffa Asks Common Expiry Date

DETROIT (AP) — Teamsters union President James R. Hoffa

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